

the name of the Persian king, then the low estimate of the man and the utter confusion wrought in the book, as set forth in Chapter I, are inevitable. If he did not write it, then the whole modern theory of his book, with the tissue of contradictions and the chimera of a 'Trito-Isaiah,' is gone in a twinkling. It will be seen, when the passages are examined, that the 'Cyrus-exile' element is present only in a few small and purely superficial spots, dabbed on, as it were, in an easy-going way by some one who felt that he could render a useful service by making plain what was obscure. When the spots are removed—and they come off very easily, leaving no mark—the *meter of each passage is for the first time in order*, and there remains in the whole prophecy no suggestion either of Jews in Babylonia or of a foreign potentate.

1. The "Cyrus" Interpolations in 45:1 and 44:28

It has already been shown, in Chapter II, how terms definitely applied by the prophet to *Israel*, as God's 'elect,' the one who was 'called from the ends of the earth,' 'whose right hand God holds,' who is to 'perform all his pleasure,' who is to 'thresh mountains, and make the hills as chaff,' scattering all foes like a whirlwind, are in 45:1 ff. applied to *Cyrus*; and if in this passage, then presumably in others—with confusion as the result. Logically, all these passages should refer to the same chosen instrument of God's purpose; in fact, they cannot possibly all be made to refer to Cyrus, and the attempt to fit them to him necessitates in every case some slight alteration of the text. Do they not, then, all refer to Israel, or Israel's representative? Has the mention of Cyrus by name a place in the Hebrew text which is above suspicion?

There are probably not many who realize how strong is the merely textual evidence against the word *lě-Kōresh*, "to Cyrus," in 45:1. The fact is, it is metrically superfluous, and so distinctly so, that this one fact is sufficient of itself to mark it as a probable interpolation. The metric verse originally read as follows:

kōh āmār Yahwē limēšichō, | āšēr hechēzāqtī bimānō.

To one who glances at Professor Cheyne's edition of the Hebrew, where the text is printed in metric lines, the length of this particular line, with the name added, cannot fail to attract attention. There is nothing else like it on the whole page; all the other lines are of about the same length, but the one word *lě-Kōresh* projects beyond the margin, and stares the reader in the face. When the